

WINCHESTER RFC

U14 SUMMER TRAINING PROGRAMME



Conditioning & Skills · Pathway-Aligned · Summer 2026

1 coached Thursday + 2 self-led sessions/week
Mid June – end August · North Walls Park ·

Preparing players
for U14 rugby

11

Thursdays

3

Sessions / week

90

Mins (Thursday)

Jun–
Aug

Summer window

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1. PROGRAMME INTRODUCTION:



Welcome to the summer of fun!

As we look ahead to the U14's season, we've pulled together this document to help parents and our players understand the fundamentals of how they should be looking to train, condition and prepare for the U14's season. This document is a partner piece to the already provided Transition to U14's document where we layout and highlight the key differences between U13's and U14's.

These differences will, by necessity, drive a more structured approach to how we prepare, coach and execute the U14's season. Essentially the U14's season is a transition year. This is a deliberate "by design" RFU pathway, bridging the step up from children's rugby to the junior game. The laws, pitch size and team shape all move closer to the adult version of the game – again, by design.

What does this mean for the players:

- **Structure:** *Players will start to learn true positional roles and sub-units will grow in importance creating the foundation for the 15 player team.*
- **Space:** *More space to manage and take advantage of while adjusting to the 15 player game*
- **Set piece:** *Scrum, line outs and mauls grows in importance and start to be used as an attacking weapon /opportunity to launch plays.*
- **Dimensions:** *More options to take advantage of on both sides of the ball – such as kicking in all aspects of the game and the addition of flankers.*
- **Strategy:** *What we do based on where we are - understanding the different zones on the pitch and what we are trying to achieve in those zones*

The immediate implication for all of the above is that conditioning and preparation levels will need to step up and we will look to provide a more holistic level of guidance in order to support consistency across development & performance.

This document lays out how we should look to train both as a club/team and as individuals during the upcoming summer season. Finally, with our progression to an older age group we will look to understand how we incorporate approaches and techniques to support objectives like player led goals, player led consistency & team developmental goals both on and off the field.

Martin & The U14 Coaching Team

PROGRAMME OVERVIEW



THURSDAY



Coached • 90 mins

WRFC Club— with coaches

Skill Zone (30 mins) + Touch/Tag
Game Zone (30–40 mins). Non-
contact June–July. Adapted contact
from August.

SELF-LED A



Solo / pair • 45 mins

Anywhere outdoors — no equipment

Athletic Development: aerobic base,
sprint capacity, explosive power

SELF-LED B



Solo / pair • 45 mins

Park, field, or open space

Fundamental Skills: Catch & Pass,
Carry, Tackle, Breakdown

PROGRAMME PHASES — 11 WEEK OVERVIEW



PHASE 1

Mid June – mid July (Sessions 1–4)



THURSDAY

Non-contact. Skill Zone: Catch & Pass, Carry technique. Touch/tag Game Zone 30–40 mins.



SELF-LED A

Steady aerobic runs • Core activation • Bodyweight strength



SELF-LED B

Passing (both hands) • Catch & carry • Footwork grids

PHASE 2

Mid July – end July (Sessions 5–8)



THURSDAY

Non-contact. Skill Zone: Breakdown, Tackle technique intro (bag/pads). Tag game with structure: shape, calls, set-piece reads.



SELF-LED A

Rugby intervals • Sprint sets • T-drill agility • Explosive circuits



SELF-LED B

2v1/3v2 decisions • Tackle footwork • Lineout throw • Kicking intro

PHASE 3

August (Sessions 9–11)



THURSDAY

Adapted Contact Game On (from 1 Aug, RFU Reg 15.8.6). Skill Zone transitions to adapted contact drills. Full touch/tag or adapted game.



SELF-LED A

Speed & agility • Fly 30s • 505 drill • Plyometrics



SELF-LED B

High-tempo passing under fatigue • Decision drills • Kicking challenge

WEEKLY SCHEDULE — MID JUNE TO END AUGUST 2026



MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Self-led A Conditioning 45 mins	Rest or active recovery	Self-led B Skills 45 mins	THURSDAY Coached session 90 mins 19 Jun → 28 Aug	Rest	Rest or light activity	Rest

11 Thursdays: 19 Jun, 26 Jun, 3 Jul, 10 Jul, 17 Jul, 24 Jul, 31 Jul, 7 Aug, 14 Aug, 21 Aug, 28 Aug · June–July = non-contact · August = Adapted Contact



Format: 10 min warm-up • 30 min Skill Zone (non-contact) • 35 min Touch/Tag Game Zone • 15 min cool-down & debrief • No full contact

19 Jun • Session 1

Catch & Pass — Pillar 1

- Skill Zone (30 mins): passing pairs stationary → moving → game-speed, both hands. 3-man channel at pace. Footwork grid: direction change, cuts, acceleration
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): must complete 3 passes before touching down. Decision-making under play, not just drills. Key habit: always lead the receiver, follow through
- Debrief: passing observations + U14 laws walk-through

26 Jun • Session 2

Carry & Evasion — Pillar 2

- Skill Zone (30 mins): gate running — body lean and line-running. 1v0 step, swerve, dummy at pace. Ball security: two-handed carry, never one-handed when tagged
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): ball carrier must beat one 'touch' before passing (earns bonus point). Forces carrying decisions, not just quick offloads
- Debrief: Outstanding Behaviours — support lines, communication, attitude to errors

3 Jul • Session 3

Shape in Attack — Game Understanding

- Skill Zone (30 mins): 2v1 — carrier commits, passes to support. 3v2 — find the space. Width: stay in lanes, no bunching. Cue: read defender's hips, not feet
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): structured phases — must complete 3 phases before scoring. Shape, calls, communication coached throughout
- Debrief: most common error identified by players, not coaches. Key habit: call your name loudly

10 Jul • Session 4

Defence & Line Speed — Game Understanding

- Skill Zone (30 mins): defensive line — flat, step up on touch, verbal calls. Blitz vs drift: read carrier's hips, communicate the choice. 1v1 jockey footwork drill
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): defensive scoring — bonus point for 3 consecutive stops. Creates real defensive intensity and communication habits
- Debrief: what calls worked? What needs to be louder? Set personal communication targets



Format: 10 min warm-up • 30 min Skill Zone (non-contact) • 35 min Touch/Tag Game Zone • 15 min cool-down & debrief • Still non-contact — no full tackle or scrums

17 Jul • Session 5

Set Piece Shape (Non-Contact)

- Skill Zone (30 mins): lineout alignment, calling, straight throw (hookers). 8-man scrum formation, CBS sequence, #8 pick-up — movement reps, no contact. Scrum-half decision tree: pass, pick, run, box kick
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): all restarts via lineout free pass or scrum tap. Must exit own half to score. Set-piece knowledge applied under game pressure
- Debrief: what did backs do while forwards set the lineout? Key habit: backs 10m back, every time

24 Jul • Session 6

Kicking Game — Game Understanding

- Skill Zone (30 mins): punt and box kick (9s & 10s). Kick-chase pairs. Chip/grubber for backs. Kick receipt: full-back positioning under the ball, 'mark' call, team communication
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): kicking permitted. Bonus point for kick-and-chase that prevents a restart. Rewards tactical kicking and chasing work rate
- Debrief: when did we kick well? When should we have kept it? Key habit: kick with a purpose

31 Jul • Session 7

Breakdown Technique (Bags/Pads)

- Skill Zone (30 mins): ball presentation on bags — two hands, away from body. Ruck entry: low hips, bind, drive. Jackal: timing, legal body position. All on pads — build correct habits before live contact begins
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): after a touch, carrier presents — support arrives and secures. Defenders respect simulated ruck. Breakdown reads without contact
- Debrief: arriving low, through the gate? Players self-correct in pairs. Habit: make the picture better

7 Aug • Session 8

Tackle Technique (Pads) + Contact Prep

- Skill Zone (30 mins): tackle footwork on pads — close space, low position, drive through hips. Head to side, below armpits, wrap and drive. Jackal off the pad. From 1 Aug, Adapted Contact Game On permitted — coaches may introduce light live contact
- Touch/Tag Game Zone (35 mins): players call decisions aloud — 'ruck', 'mine', 'yours'. Final non-contact game. Verbal habit-building before full adapted contact begins
- Debrief: contact readiness — what are we confident about? What needs more work in August?

Adapted contact game available from 1 August for U14+. No full scrums or mauls. Progressive contact reintroduction.

14 Aug • Session 9

Contact Reintroduction

- Warm-up includes RFU Activate programme (15 mins, permitted as an addition to session time)
- Skill Zone: tackle technique reintroduced — bag work, then live low-speed contact. Correct technique first, speed second. Head to side, below armpits, wrap and drive
- Ruck entry live: 2v1 carry and present. Support arrives and secures. No maul yet
- Adapted Game Zone: touch/tag rules still apply for most of game — last 15 mins introduce live tackles. No scrums yet. Adapted U14 laws: lineout free pass restart.
- Debrief: contact technique observations. Any welfare concerns addressed immediately

21 Aug • Session 10

Full Skills Under Pressure

- Skill Zone: Catch & Pass at pace, carry through contact (tackle bags + live), breakdown competition (2v1 ruck), tackle technique
- Set piece walk-throughs: lineout mechanics, scrum binding and engagement (no full push yet)
- 2v1 and 3v2 attack patterns — running at full intensity, game-speed decisions
- Adapted Game Zone (35 mins): live tackles permitted throughout. No contested scrums — lineout or tap restart. Full-pitch adapted game. Game Understanding and Behaviours both assessed
- Debrief: this is the closest we've been to a September match. What do players feel confident about? What needs September pre-season work?

28 Aug • Session 11

Internal Trial*

- Pre-session: team sheet shared. Players briefed on positional roles. Coaches observe — do not direct
- Skill Zone (20 mins): individual warm-up with ball — each player demonstrates their Catch & Pass, carrying line, and tackle approach to the observing coaches
- Adapted internal trial (40 mins): 2 × 20-min halves. Live tackle, lineout restarts, tap from scrum base. No contested scrums per August Adapted Contact format
- Coaches observe all four pillars: Game Understanding, Outstanding Behaviours, Athletic Potential, Fundamental Skills
- Post-match: individual player feedback. Families invited to speak to coaching team after session

*Proposed idea for a pre-season trial game as a means to aim for a constructive target and maintain focus over

SELF-LED A — CONDITIONING: WEEKS 1-3 (AEROBIC BASE)

FOUNDATION



Once per week on any day except Thursday · 45 mins · Trainers only — no equipment needed

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
Dynamic warm-up	5 mins	Easy	Leg swings, arm circles, hip rotations, walking knee drives. Never skip this.
Steady-state run	20-25 mins	Conversational	Should be able to speak a short sentence. If you can't, slow down. Build to 25 mins by week 3.
Strides	4 × 80m	75-80%	Walk back after each rep. Run tall — drive knees, pump arms, don't hunch forward.
Bodyweight core circuit	2 rounds	Moderate	Plank 30s · Glute bridge 15 · Dead bug 10 each side · Side plank 20s each. Rest 60s between rounds.
Cool-down walk + stretch	5 mins	Easy	Hip flexor, quad, hamstring, calf — hold each for 30 seconds. Don't rush this.



Athletic Development pillar:

Athletic Potential — speed, endurance, power, and movement quality. U14 pitches are 100m × 70m: players who can sustain high-intensity work across 50 mins stand out immediately. Teams capable of sustaining high intensity play will give naturally have a competitive edge in the final quarter of any game. Endurance and stamina will support low unforced error metrics during ball in play moments.

SELF-LED A — CONDITIONING: WEEKS 4-6 (RUGBY INTERVALS)

BUILD



Once per week on any day except Thursday · 45 mins · Trainers only — no equipment needed

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
Dynamic warm-up	8 mins	Moderate	Add lateral shuffles and change-of-direction work to the standard warm-up routine.
Tempo intervals	6 × 3 mins	80% effort	3 mins effort / 90s walk recovery. Breathing hard but not sprinting. Aim: 75–85% max HR if you have a monitor.
Rugby sprint sets	6 × 40m	95–100%	Full-speed 40m from standing. Full rest between reps (45–60s walk). Rugby-distance sprint — train what you'll use.
Agility: T-drill	4 reps	95%+	4 cones in a T shape (5m, 10m). Sprint forward, shuffle left, shuffle right, backpedal. Time yourself — beat it each week.
Core + strength circuit	3 rounds	Moderate	Squat jumps 8 · Press-ups 15 · Forward lunges 12 each leg · Plank 45s · Glute bridge 20. Rest 90s between rounds.
Cool-down + stretch	5 mins	Easy	Full static stretch — quad, hip flexor, calf, hamstring, thoracic rotation.

SELF-LED A — CONDITIONING: WEEKS 7-8 (SPEED & MATCH READINESS)

PEAK



Once per week on any day except Thursday · 45 mins · Reduce volume, increase quality

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
Extended dynamic warm-up	10 mins	Moderate	Include A-skip, B-skip, bounding, and hip rotations. Activate fast-twitch muscle groups before sprint work.
Acceleration runs	6 × 20m	100%	From standing start. Focus on first 3 steps — lean forward aggressively. Full rest between every rep (60s+).
Fly 30s	4 × 30m	100%	Walk 20m to build up, then sprint the marked 30m at full pace. Develops top-end speed. Full rest between reps.
505 change-of-direction	5 reps/side	95%+	Sprint 5m to a cone, plant and turn 180°, sprint 5m back. Alternate left and right. Time yourself — be competitive.
Plyometric circuit	2 rounds	Explosive	Squat jumps 6 · Broad jumps 6 · Lateral bounds 8 each · Press-up claps 6. Rest 2 mins between rounds.
Cool-down + stretch	8–10 mins	Easy	Longer cool-down in week 8 — you're heading into trial match week. Full static stretch, slow deep breathing.

SELF-LED B — SKILLS: WEEKS 1-3 (FUNDAMENTALS)

FOUNDATION



Once per week · 45 mins · Ball + training partner recommended · Park or open space

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
Passing pairs — stationary	5 mins	Passing	5m apart. Alternate left and right hands. Fingers spread, swing from hip, good follow-through. Aim for a spiral.
Passing pairs — moving	5 mins	Passing	Both jogging. Receiver steps to the ball, passer leads in front. Gradually increase pace. Swap directions.
Footwork / cone grid	10 mins	Footwork & agility	8 cones in a 2m-wide corridor, 1m apart. High knees, lateral shuffles, in-out, one-foot. Restart immediately after each run.
Catch & carry under cones	8 mins	Carrying	5 cones in a line, 4m apart. Sprint through at pace, presenting ball at each cone as if going to ground. Low body position.
1v0 evasion run	8 mins	Evasion & footwork	Sprint 15m, execute a step/swerve/dummy at the halfway mark. Alternate direction each rep. Focus on body shape.



Fundamental Skills pillar:

Catch & Pass quality — accuracy, both hands, under movement and light pressure. Clean hands over 8 weeks of deliberate practice will be visible at the start of the season.

SELF-LED B — SKILLS: WEEKS 4–6 (RUGBY-SPECIFIC)

BUILD



Once per week · 45 mins · Ball + training partner recommended · Park or open space

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
Moving passing — pace & accuracy	8 mins	Passing	Partner drill at 3/4 pace. Hips square to direction of travel while passing. Count consecutive clean catches — no drops.
Ball presentation — solo	5 mins	Breakdown	Sprint 10m, dive to ground, present ball two-handed away from body. Get up, jog back, repeat. Clean presentation every time.
Lineout throw (hookers)	10 mins	Set piece	HOOKERS: Practice straight two-handed throw to a cone or partner. Aim for consistency, not power. OTHERS: passing reps.
1v1 decision drill	10 mins	Decision making	Carrier vs defender in a 10m × 5m channel. Carrier must beat defender. Defender: low position and footwork. Swap roles.
Box kick intro (9s & 10s)	8 mins	Kicking	Drop ball onto foot, strike bottom third. Aim for height and spiral. Land on the same spot each kick. Others: chip or punt.

SELF-LED B — SKILLS: WEEKS 7-8 (MATCH INTENSITY)

PEAK



Once per week · 45 mins · Ball + 2 training partners ideal · Park or open space

Exercise / drill	Volume	Intensity	How to do it / coaching note
High-tempo passing square	8 mins	Passing under fatigue	4 cones in a 10m square. Pass and follow your pass around the square at near-sprint pace. Drops = 5 press-ups.
Carry → present → pass sequence	8 mins	Breakdown & continuity	Run 10m, go to ground, present, partner picks and passes to a third. Cycle through roles. Add defender in week 8.
Decision drill under fatigue	10 mins	Decision making	3v2 attack on 25m channel. After each rep the attackers do 5 squat jumps before going again. Mirrors match conditions.
Kicking accuracy challenge	8 mins	Kicking	4 cones at 10m, 15m, 20m, 25m. Kick to land between or hit each cone. Drop kick or punt. Keep score — beat it each session.
Cool-down + visualisation	5 mins	Recovery	Static stretch, then 2 mins quiet time: visualise executing one skill well in a match. Simple but genuinely effective.

PROPOSED AIMS FOR THE SEASON



This programme is built to develop all four key pillars.

1

Game Understanding

What we assess:

Reading the game — shape in attack and defence, knowing where to be, making correct decisions under pressure, what's my next job.

Thursday sessions use the Game Zone model: real game situations where players must read and decide. Weeks 4–7 focus specifically on attack shape, defensive reads, and set-piece understanding.

2

Outstanding Behaviours

What we assess:

Attitude, coachability, communication on the pitch, effort, and how a player carries themselves in a team environment.

Embedded in every session. Self-led sessions build discipline and self-management. Thursday debriefs emphasise communication. Week 8 trial specifically assesses behaviour without direct coaching.

3

Athletic Potential

What we assess:

Speed, endurance, power, agility, and movement quality. Not just current fitness* — potential to develop physically.

Self-led A is entirely dedicated to this pillar: aerobic base (weeks 1–3) → rugby intervals and agility (weeks 4–6) → speed and explosive power (weeks 7–8).

4

Fundamental Skills

What we assess:

Catch & Pass, Carry, Tackle, and Breakdown — the four core skills coached and monitored at every session.

Self-led B targets these directly. Thursday Skill Zone blocks practice each skill with progressive pressure and decision-making. All four are covered across the 8-week programme.



Benchmark assessment

*Do we want to benchmark this at the end of summer pre-season and use as a baseline to index progress at mid-season and end of season?

PLAYER WELFARE 1



PLAYER WELFARE – it is critical that players start to understand the role they play in their own welfare



Always warm up (5 mins minimum) before any session. Cold muscles are far more prone to injury. Take longer to warm up if you don't feel properly loose. Proper warm ups play a key role in injury prevention and mitigation (see follow on slides).



Cool down and stretch after every session — especially after sprint and conditioning work (see follow on slides).



If you feel pain (not effort — actual sharp or persistent pain), stop and rest. Tell a parent and your coach immediately.



In hot weather: reduce intensity, **increase hydration**, move sessions to early morning or evening. Ensure you hydrate before, during and after all sessions. If you feel thirsty its too late. Monitor the color of your urine. Getting your hydration levels right takes time and attention – everyone has their own levels of hydration and you need to learn yours.



The body needs plenty of clean lean protein, complex carbs, fiber and healthy fats to support growth and recovery and prevent immune systems from being run down with an increase in training volumes.



Sleep is when the body adapts, grows and recovers. Aim for 8–9 hours minimum per night throughout the programme.



Never train on consecutive days if carrying an injury. A week off now beats missing pre-season. Smart decision making during pre-season will mean you're not carrying an injury during the season. Rehabbing an injury correctly is far more important than the impact of training with an injury which will only compound the root cause of the issue – meaning a longer recovery.



WARMING UP — WHY IT MATTERS

Every session starts here. Non-negotiable.

INJURY PREVENTION

Cold muscles tear. Warm muscles bend. A 10-minute warm-up raises muscle temperature, increases blood flow, and prepares tendons and ligaments for explosive loads. At U14, your body is still developing — skipping the warm-up is the single biggest cause of avoidable injuries in junior rugby.

RFU Activate is our standard warm-up for Thursday sessions.

PERFORMANCE GAINS

A proper warm-up improves reaction time, sprint speed, and passing accuracy from the first minute of a session. Neural pathways activate, joints lubricate, and your cardiovascular system ramps up. Players who warm up properly perform better immediately — not just later in the session.

For self-led sessions: 5 mins minimum, always.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

5-10 mins every session:

Leg swings, arm circles, hip rotations
Walking knee drives, lateral shuffles
A-skips, bounding, change of direction
Gentle jog building to strides

Thursday sessions use RFU Activate (Phase 3).

WARMING DOWN & RECOVERY

Where the adaptation happens. Don't skip it.

THE SCIENCE

Training breaks the body down.
Recovery builds it back stronger.
Muscles grow, aerobic fitness improves, and neural pathways sharpen during rest — **not during the session**. A warm-down signals the body to switch from “performance” mode to “repair” mode. Without it, you carry more fatigue into the next session.

SLEEP & NUTRITION

8–9 hours of sleep is the most powerful recovery tool available to a U14 player. Growth hormone — responsible for muscle repair and development — is released primarily during deep sleep. Eat within 60 minutes of finishing a session: carbohydrates to restore energy, protein to repair muscle.
No sleep shortcut exists. 8–9 hrs. Every night. Sleep deficits cannot be recovered.

WARM-DOWN ROUTINE

5 mins after every session:

Easy jog or walk (2 mins)
Hip flexor stretch — 30s each side
Quad & hamstring stretch — 30s each
Calf & thoracic rotation — 30s each
See Self-Led A sessions for full cool-down detail.

WINCHESTER RFC

Work hard. See you on the pitch.

Black and Amber · Season 2026-27

U14 Summer Training Programme · 1 coached Thursday session + 2 self-led sessions/week ·

North Walls Park, Winchester · winchesterrugby.com ·

APPENDIX

Self-Led Activities Illustrated Guide

Visual drill diagrams and coaching cues for all self-led sessions

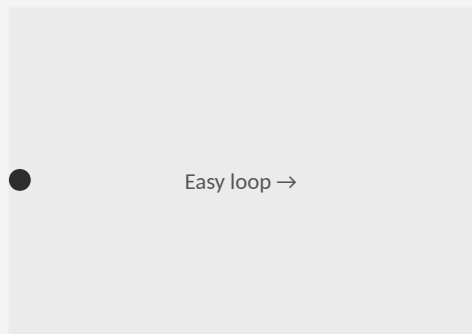
- A2 Conditioning Phase 1 — Aerobic base, strides & core (Weeks 1–3)
- A3 Conditioning Phase 2 — Rugby intervals, sprint sets & agility (Weeks 4–6)
- A4 Conditioning Phase 3 — Speed, 505 drill & plyometrics (Weeks 7–8)
- A5 Skills Phase 1 — Passing pairs, catch & carry, footwork, evasion (Weeks 1–3)
- A6 Skills Phase 2 — 1v1 channel, lineout throw, 2v1 grid, box kick (Weeks 4–6)
- A7 Skills Phase 3 — Passing square, 3v2 fatigue, kicking targets (Weeks 7–8)
- A8 Quick reference — all drills, volumes & phase progressions

Once per week • No equipment needed — just trainers • 45 mins • Builds aerobic engine for the full-size U14 pitch

1 Steady-state run

- ▶ 20 mins (wk 1–2) → 25 mins (wk 3)
- ▶ Easy, conversational pace. Run tall: drive knees, pump arms
- ▶ Can speak a short sentence? Good. If not — slow down
- ▶ Park loop or road circuit. Any flat route works

① Run route — steady loop



2 Strides — 4 × 80m

- ▶ 75–80% effort. Walk back after each rep
- ▶ Not a sprint — smooth, powerful, controlled
- ▶ Focus: running mechanics. High knees, forward lean
- ▶ 80m = roughly the length of a touch pitch

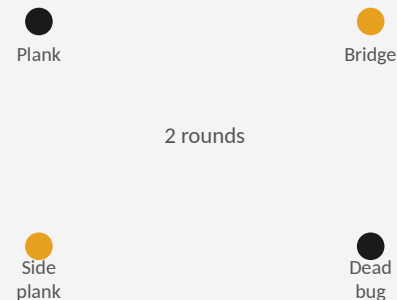
② Stride — 80m, walk back



3 Core circuit — 2 rounds

- ▶ Plank hold — 30 seconds
- ▶ Glute bridge — 15 reps
- ▶ Dead bug — 10 each side
- ▶ Side plank — 20s each side
- ▶ 60s rest between rounds. 5-min stretch after

③ Core circuit — rotate through 4 stations

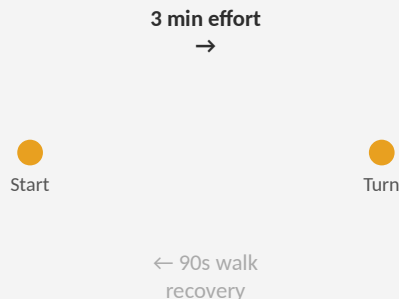


Once per week • 45 mins • Rugby-specific work: short, sharp efforts that mirror real match demands. No equipment needed.

1 Tempo intervals 6×3 min

- ▶ 3-min effort / 90s walk × 6 rounds
- ▶ 80% effort — breathing hard, not sprinting
- ▶ Out-and-back flat route. Mark your turnaround

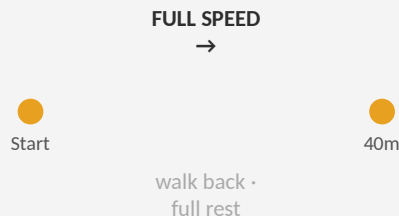
① Tempo intervals — out & back route



2 Rugby sprints 6×40m

- ▶ Full-speed from standing. 45–60s full rest between
- ▶ 40m = rugby distance — train what you use
- ▶ Arms pump hard, lean forward off the line

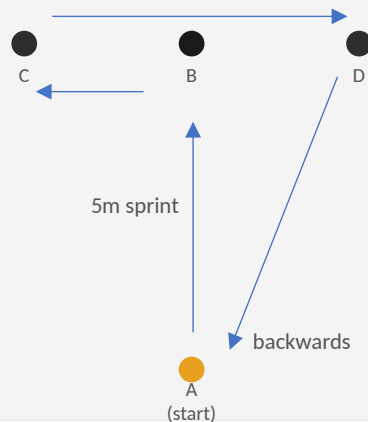
② Rugby sprints — 40m, full rest



3 T-drill agility — 4 reps

- ▶ A→B: sprint 5m to centre cone
- ▶ B→C: shuffle left 2.5m
- ▶ C→D: shuffle right 5m
- ▶ D→B: shuffle back, backpedal to A

③ T-drill — cone layout



4 Strength circuit 3 rounds

- ▶ Squat jumps × 8
- ▶ Press-ups × 15
- ▶ Forward lunges × 12 each
- ▶ Plank × 45s
- ▶ Glute bridge × 20
- ▶ 90s rest between rounds

④ Strength circuit stations

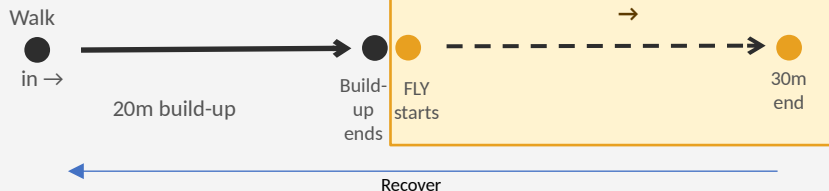


Once per week • 45 mins • Reduce volume, maximise quality. Arrive at pre-season physically sharp and explosive.

1 Fly 30s — 4 reps

- ▶ Walk 20m to build speed, then sprint the marked 30m at 100%
- ▶ Full rest between reps (60s+). Top-end speed — not conditioning
- ▶ Focus: fastest you'll run all summer. Make every rep count

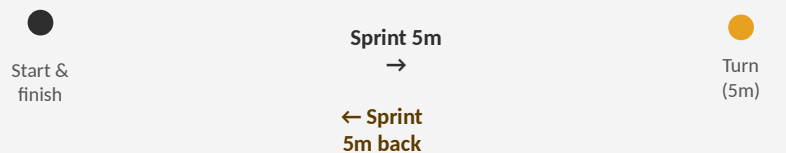
① Fly 30s — layout



2 505 change-of-direction — 5 each side

- ▶ Sprint 5m to cone, plant foot, turn 180°, sprint 5m back
- ▶ Alternate: left-foot plant, right-foot plant
- ▶ The turn is everything — stay low, drive hard off the plant foot
- ▶ Time yourself and try to beat it each session

② 505 drill — layout



③ Plyometric circuit — 2 rounds • 2 mins rest between

**Squat
Jumps**

6 reps

Land soft, reload

**Broad
Jumps**

6 reps

Swing arms forward

**Lateral
Bounds**

8 each

Push off one foot

**Press-up
Claps**

6 reps

Explosive push

Ball + partner recommended • 45 mins • Focus: Catch & Pass standard and carrying foundations

1

Passing pairs (10 min)

- ▶ 5m apart, lateral movement while passing
- ▶ Both hands: swing from hip, follow through, spiral
- ▶ Lead the receiver out in front
- ▶ Walk → jog → 3/4 pace over the 10 mins

① Passing pairs — side to side



2

Footwork grid (10 min)

- ▶ 8 cones in 2m corridor, 1m apart
- ▶ High knees • lateral shuffle • in-out • single foot
- ▶ Restart immediately after each pass through
- ▶ Keep hips low throughout

② Footwork cone grid

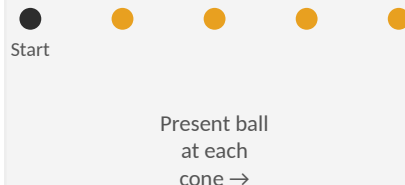


3

Catch & carry (8 min)

- ▶ 5 cones in a line, 4m apart
- ▶ Sprint at pace. At each cone: present ball, low position
- ▶ Two hands, ball away from body
- ▶ Get up quickly, accelerate to next cone

③ Catch & carry — 5 cones in line



4

1v0 evasion run (8 min)

- ▶ 2 cones 15m apart
- ▶ Sprint end to end, execute step/swerve/dummy at midpoint
- ▶ Alternate direction each rep
- ▶ Focus: body shape and footwork at pace

④ Evasion run — step at midpoint

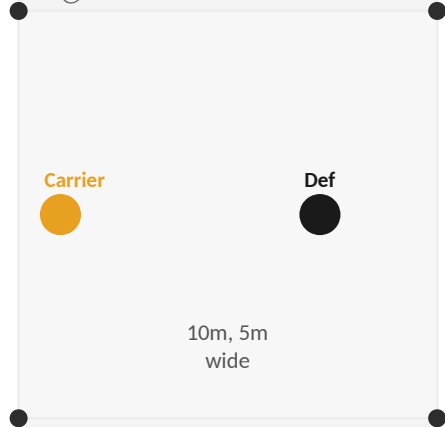


Partner *needed for most drills* • 45 mins • Decision-making and position-specific skills

1 1v1 decision (10 min)

- ▶ 10m channel, 5m wide. Carrier vs defender
- ▶ Carrier must beat the defender — not pass away
- ▶ Defender: low position, footwork, timing
- ▶ Swap roles after each rep. Work both sides

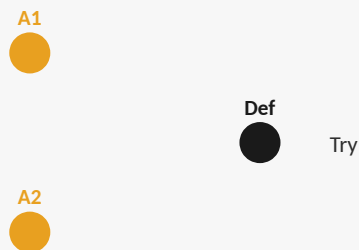
① 1v1 — 10m × 5m channel



2 2v1 attack (10 min)

- ▶ 2 attackers vs 1 defender. 20m × 10m channel
- ▶ Carrier: commit defender — then pass or beat
- ▶ Cue: read defender's hips. When they commit, pass
- ▶ Support: stay wide, call your name

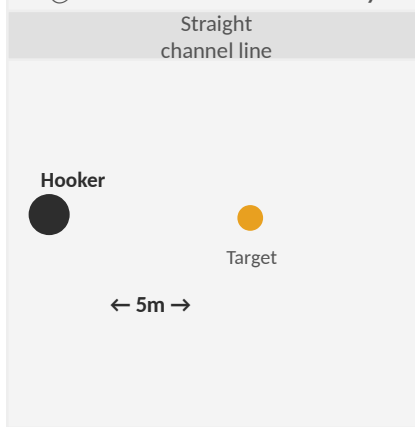
② 2v1 — carrier commits, pass wide



3 Lineout throw — hookers (10 min)

- ▶ Mark a straight channel line on the ground
- ▶ 5m from target — throw to cone or partner's hands
- ▶ Two-handed throw. Consistency over power
- ▶ Non-hookers: use time for passing reps

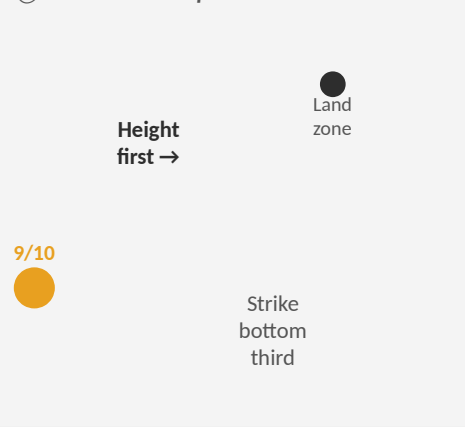
③ Lineout throw — 5m accuracy



4 Box kick — 9s & 10s (8 min)

- ▶ Drop ball onto foot, strike bottom third
- ▶ Height first, then direction. Aim for spiral
- ▶ Land on same spot every rep — consistency
- ▶ Others: chip/punt to a marked target area

④ Box kick — drop and strike



2 training partners ideal → 45 mins • High tempo under fatigue

1 Passing square (8 min)

- ▶ 4 cones in a 10m square. 4 players (or 3 + cone)
- ▶ Pass and follow your pass around the square at sprint pace
- ▶ No stopping between passes. Drops = 5 press-ups each

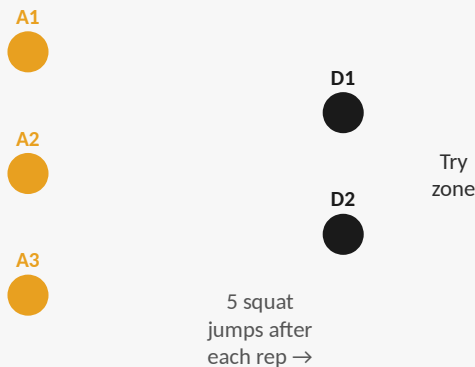
① Passing square — 10m × 10m



2 3v2 under fatigue (10 min)

- ▶ 3 attackers vs 2 defenders. 25m channel
- ▶ After each rep: attackers do 5 squat jumps before going again
- ▶ Mirrors the physical and mental load of a real game

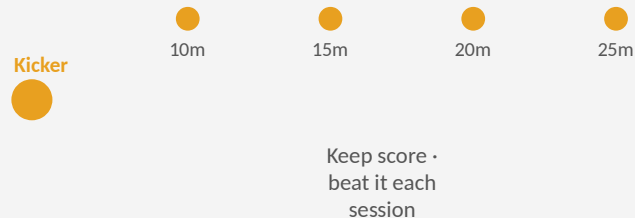
② 3v2 — find the space, execute



3 Kicking targets (8 min)

- ▶ 4 cones at 10m, 15m, 20m, 25m
- ▶ Kick to land between / hit each cone
- ▶ Drop kick or punt. Keep score — beat it each session

③ Kicking targets — 4 distances



SESSION A — CONDITIONING				SESSION B — SKILLS			
Drill	Volume	Intensity	Phase	Drill	Volume	Intensity	Phase
Steady-state run	20–25 mins	Easy	Ph 1	Passing pairs	10 mins	Moving	Ph 1
Strides	4 × 80m	75–80%	Ph 1	Footwork grid	10 mins	Agility	Ph 1
Core circuit	2 rounds	Moderate	Ph 1	Catch & carry	8 mins	Ball skill	Ph 1
Tempo intervals	6×3 mins	80%	Ph 2	1v0 evasion	8 mins	Footwork	Ph 1
Rugby sprints	6×40m	95–100%	Ph 2	1v1 decision	10 mins	Decision	Ph 2
T-drill agility	4 reps	95%+	Ph 2	Lineout throw	10 mins	Set piece	Ph 2
Strength circuit	3 rounds	Moderate	Ph 2	2v1 attack	10 mins	Decision	Ph 2
Fly 30s	4×30m	100%	Ph 3	Box kick	8 mins	Kicking	Ph 2
505 drill	5 each side	95%+	Ph 3	Passing square	8 mins	High tempo	Ph 3
Plyometrics	2 rounds	Explosive	Ph 3	3v2 fatigue	10 mins	Decision	Ph 3
Cool-down	5–10 mins	Easy	All	Kicking targets	8 mins	Kicking	Ph 3